

MODULE-3

SEVEN C's AND FOUR S's

OF EFFECTIVE COMMUNICATION



DR.UNAIS KT
NIT GOA

Enjoy Reading



May I Smoke?

Jack and Max are walking from the religious service. Jack wonders whether it would be all right to smoke while praying. Max replies: “Why don’t you ask the Priest?” So Jack goes up the Priest and asks: “Priest, may I smoke while I pray?” Priest says: “No, my son, you may not, that’s utter disrespect to our religion.” Jack goes up and tells his friend what the good Priest told him. Max says: “I’m not surprised. You asked the wrong question. Let me try.” And so, Max goes up the Priest and asks: “Priest, may I pray while I smoke.” To which the Priest eagerly replies: “By all means my son, by all means.” —Anonymous

Introduction



- Good communication skills are obviously a very valuable employability characteristic.
- The work environment responds positively to effectively communicated ideas, knowledge and company-related proposals.
- Especially in this fast-paced era where technology has made connecting people so much easier, more is expected of employees.

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- The seven C's of communication are a list of principles or values for people to apply to their communication.
- These C's can guide your communication by helping you create clear messages that accurately portray information to others.
- You might use the seven C's as a checklist to ensure that you communicate properly.

7C's of effective communication



- Credibility
- Courtesy
- Clarity
- Correctness
- Consistency
- Concreteness
- Conciseness

1. Credibility



- Building the trust is important for the effective communication.
- Establishing credibility is not the outcome of a one shot statement.
- It is a long drawn out process in which the receiver, through constant interaction with sender respects credibility and is willing to accept the statements as being truthful and honest

Example



- “Research from Harvard University shows that sleep deprivation reduces cognitive function by up to 40%.”
- (Here, the credibility comes from the citation of a reputable institution, which makes the statement more trustworthy.)

2. Courtesy



- Courteous communication is friendly, open, and honest, there are no hidden insults or passive-aggressive tones. You keep your reader's viewpoint in mind, and you're empathetic to their needs.
- Be Sincerely Tactful, Thoughtful and Appreciative.
- Use Expressions that Show Respect.
- Omit expressions that irritate, or hurt.
- Choose Non-discriminatory Expressions.
- Courteous message help to strengthen present business friendships, as well as make new friends.

Courtesy strengthens relationship

Example



- “I appreciate your time and effort in reviewing this proposal. If you have any questions, feel free to reach out, and I’ll be happy to clarify.”
- (This statement shows politeness and consideration for the audience’s time and needs.)

3. Clarity



- Clear communication is the Third C. Clarity requires you to deliver your message without adding unnecessary or confusing vocabulary, phrasing and terminology. A clear delivery may relax listeners, helping them feel confident about the information you share. Here are some ways you can improve clarity:
 - Limit your use of idioms or omit them entirely
 - Decrease use of overly technical terms or jargon
 - Preface technical terms with introductions
 - Omit slang terms
 - Use active voice and present tense

Example



- “The meeting will be held at 10 AM on Wednesday in Room 204.”
- (There’s no confusion—clear time, date, and location.)

4. Correctness



- The fourth C refers to correct communication. Ensure your communication is factual and grammatically accurate to ensure your listener receives correct information. If an audience is aware of an error, this may distract them from the rest of your message.
- Additionally, incorrect information can reduce your credibility in future communication opportunities. Correct communication is more effective because it demonstrates your care to provide accurate information to your audience.

Example



- “The capital of France is Paris.”
- (This is both grammatically correct and factually accurate.)

5. Consistency



- The fifth C of communication is consistency. Coherence often comes from the structure of a message.
- Organizing your message so that each idea flows neatly into the next makes it easier to follow and remember.
- Building logically on your introductory statements to a conclusive summary is the usual approach to essays, speeches and other communications.

Example



- If a company promotes a “green” initiative, it should consistently reflect that in its policies, marketing, and practices, such as using eco-friendly materials and reducing waste.

6. Concreteness



- It's important to ensure that your message is logical, specific and valid.
- If you're making an argument, use evidence from credible sources to enhance the concreteness of your communication.
- Adding examples to your message is a great method that demonstrates the concreteness of your argument.
- Use specific facts and figures.
- Put Action in your Verbs.
- Choose vivid, image-building words.

Example



- “Our team increased sales by 15% in the last quarter, bringing in an additional 100,000 in revenue.”
- (This gives solid, measurable information rather than just saying “sales increased.”)

7. Conciseness



- Concise statements often have a greater impact on listeners. Brief, well-delivered messages are also more memorable.
- The more details you include, the more challenging it can be for listeners to follow and recall, especially if the subject matter is new to them.
- Being concise ensures that you cover the fundamental issues or ideas in your message, making your main point clear.

Example



- Instead of saying, “I am writing to inform you that the meeting we had scheduled for tomorrow has been postponed to next Tuesday due to unforeseen circumstances,”

say:

“The meeting is postponed to next Tuesday.”

- (Here, the key message is delivered in a shorter, more direct way.)

4 S's of Communication



- 4S's of communication helps in making good and effective communication.
- 4S's are:
 1. Shortness
 2. Simplicity
 3. Strength
 4. Sincerity
- They aid in creating excellent and efficient communication—necessary for an ideal and efficient business environment.

1. Shortness



- The saying “brevity is the soul of wit” holds true for communication as well. Keeping things concise enhances clarity and impact.
- Communicate concisely, focusing on the key points. Eliminate unnecessary details to make the message clear and memorable.
- Messages filled with complex words lack impact. Many think using high-sounding words impresses, but they waste time as recipients struggle to grasp the true meaning.

Example



- Instead of saying, “I would like to express my gratitude to each and every one of you for taking out time from your busy schedules to attend this important meeting today,” say,
“Thank you for attending this meeting.”
- Purpose: Saves time and ensures clarity.

2. Simplicity



- Simplicity both in the usage of words and ideas reveals a clarity in the thinking Process.
- Using simple language that the audience can easily comprehend. Avoiding jargon, complex words, or overly technical terms.
- Reveal clarity in the thinking process by using simple terminology and equally simple concepts.

Example



- Use “Let’s meet at 3 PM” instead of “We should convene at approximately 15:00 hours.”
- Purpose: Avoids unnecessary complexity to make the message accessible to all.

3. Strength



- Communicating with confidence and credibility. Strong communication conveys authority and conviction, making the message impactful.
- A message is stronger when the sender believes in it. If the sender is confident, their words will carry more weight.
- On the other hand, if the sender is unsure or does not believe in what they are saying, it can make the communication feel insecure.

Example



- “We need this report by Friday to meet our goals” instead of “It would be nice to have the report by Friday, but if not, it’s okay.”
- Purpose: Shows confidence and assertiveness in communication.

4. Sincerity



- Being honest and genuine in communication. When the message comes from a place of sincerity, it fosters trust and connection with the audience.
- If there's even a hint of deceit from the sender, an observant receiver will likely pick up on it, which can hinder successful communication.

Example



- “I truly appreciate your hard work on this project” instead of “Great job,” when you don’t mean it.
- Purpose: Builds trust and conveys genuine feelings.

Key Differences



- The 4 S's focus on the style of delivering a message, which refers to how you communicate it effectively.
- This includes being concise, clear, and sincere in your approach, making sure your tone and delivery engage the audience and convey the message strongly.

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- On the other hand, the 7 C's emphasize the content and its completeness, ensuring that the message is well-structured and accurate.
- This includes making sure the message is clear, correct, and contains all necessary information. The 7 C's ensure that the content is thoughtful and meaningful, while the 4 S's enhance how that message is delivered for maximum impact.



Thank You !